



» PKL

RAIDER EXTRAORDINAIRE

Pardeep Narwal, the most successful raider in Pro Kabaddi League, now stands on the verge of a **defining legacy.**

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Through its decade-long journey, the Pro Kabaddi League has seen the rise of numerous stars, yet none have cast as imposing a shadow as Pardeep Narwal.

Having won three PKL trophies (with his erstwhile franchise, Patna Pirates), Narwal is one of the league's most successful raider. He was once the league's most expensive player as well, and now stands on the verge of a defining legacy.

"I feel so good to have this opportunity to play here. I got all the fame and praises after playing here, it feels complete," says Narwal to *Sportstar*. Hailing from the quaint village of Rindhana in Haryana's Sonipat district, he will now lead UP Yoddhas for the third year in a row.

But behind the glamorous spectacle and raucous cheers, he is now at a crossroad — where echoes of his past triumphs meet a challenging future.

In order to overcome his fitness struggles, Narwal dedicated himself to becoming one of the fittest players on the mat for UP this season.

"Whatever the coaches or fitness trainers say, we must follow it. I'm trying to go above and beyond. The game is all about speed and agility, so my main goal is to work on these aspects and stay on top of my game," he explains.

UP Yoddhas conducted a rigorous training camp for over a month and a half before the tournament, ensuring that all players, including Narwal, were match-ready. It also opened an academy a couple of years ago, providing players with training facilities, playing mats, a gym, and industry-standard equipment.

Yoddhas' coach Jasveer Singh chips in, "Previously, at the camps that we used to run, the players had

Leading from the front: Hailing from the quaint village of Rindhana, nestled in the heart of Haryana's Sonipat district, the 26-year-old will lead UP Yoddhas for the third year in a row. PKL